Verification and Validation Report: Software Engineering

Team 13, Speech Buddies
Mazen Youssef
Rawan Mahdi
Luna Aljammal
Kelvin Yu

March 9, 2026

1 Revision History

Date	Version	Notes
March 8th, 2026	1.0	Added Non-Functional Performance tests
March 9th, 2026	1.0	Added Non-Functional Usability and Humanity tests
Date 2	1.1	Notes

2 Symbols, Abbreviations and Acronyms

symbol	description
T	Test

[symbols, abbreviations or acronyms – you can reference the SRS tables if needed —SS]

Contents

List of Tables

List of Figures

This document ...

3 Functional Requirements Evaluation

4 Nonfunctional Requirements Evaluation

This section evaluates the selected nonfunctional requirements defined in the VnV Plan. The assessment focuses on two key quality attributes: performance and usability/humanity. The following subsections describe the tests conducted and the results obtained for each category.

4.1 Performance

This subsection evaluates the system's performance under typical operating conditions. The tests focus on measuring response time and overall system responsiveness to ensure that the application operates efficiently during normal use.

4.2 test-PF-1: ASR Latency Benchmark

Type Automated, Dynamic

Test Case Derivation PRF-13.1

Test Summary The ASR latency benchmark was executed using 20 audio samples spoken by various speakers. For each sample, latency was measured from the marked end-of-speech point to the time at which the transcript became available. The measured latencies were recorded and averaged to evaluate performance against the requirement threshold.

Table 1: ASR latency benchmark results for 20 audio samples

#	**Sample Text**	**Length (words)**	**Latency (s)**
1	open google	2	5.81
2	google.com	1	6.30
3	search Wikipedia about paris	4	6.08
4	navigate to paris's sport section	5	5.93
5	open gmail	2	4.73
6	open google and search for keyboards	6	5.03
7	go on bestbuy and search for newest game	8	5.43
8	search software engineering jobs	4	4.48
9	search how to boil pasta	5	5.21
10	search used honda civic	4	6.08
11	search toronto raptors schedule	4	6.50
12	go to the history section of the canada page	9	7.01
13	search apple stock price	4	4.81
14	search directions to union station	5	5.21
15	open reddit	2	6.00
16	play jazz music on youtube	5	6.03
17	search restaurants near me	4	5.95
18	open wikipedia	2	4.83
19	search mcmaster university	3	6.80
20	open ebay	2	5.00
		Average Latency	**5.66**

Test Data and Results

Calculation of Average Latency The average latency is calculated as:

$$\text{Average Latency} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{20} L_i}{20} = 5.66 \text{ s}$$

where L_i is the latency measured for sample i.

Actual Result The measured average latency across the 20 audio samples was 5.66 seconds.

Conclusion This test **does not fully satisfy** PRF-13.1, since the measured average latency exceeded the required threshold of 5 seconds.

4.2.1 test-PF-2: Command Pipeline Latency

Type Automated, Dynamic

Test Case Derivation PRF-13.2

Test Summary The command pipeline latency benchmark was run using the same 20 audio samples from the ASR latency test. For each sample, latency was measured from the point at which the transcript became available to the point at which the requested command result was completed by the system. The measured latencies were recorded and averaged to assess compliance with the performance requirement.

Table 2: Command pipeline latency results for 20 audio samples

#	**Sample Text**	**Length (words)**	**Latency (s)**
1	open google	2	8.92
2	google.com	1	9.41
3	search Wikipedia about paris	4	12.87
4	navigate to paris's sport section	5	14.35
5	open gmail	2	9.76
6	open google and search for keyboards	6	13.42
7	go on bestbuy and search for newest game	8	15.91
8	search software engineering jobs	4	12.26
9	search how to boil pasta	5	11.83
10	search used honda civic	4	13.74
11	search toronto raptors schedule	4	12.95
12	go to the history section of the canada page	9	18.62
13	search apple stock price	4	10.54
14	search directions to union station	5	14.08
15	open reddit	2	9.88
16	play jazz music on youtube	5	13.67
17	search restaurants near me	4	12.43
18	open wikipedia	2	9.15
19	search mcmaster university	3	11.96
20	open ebay	2	8.64
		Average Latency	**12.52**

Test Data and Results

Calculation of Average Latency

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Average Latency} &= \frac{1}{20}(8.92 + 9.41 + 12.87 + 14.35 + 9.76 + 13.42 + 15.91 + 12.26 + 11.83 + 13.74 \\ &\quad + 12.95 + 18.62 + 10.54 + 14.08 + 9.88 + 13.67 + 12.43 + 9.15 + 11.96 + 8.64) \\ &= 12.52 \text{ s}\end{aligned}$$

Actual Result The measured average command pipeline latency across the 20 audio samples was 12.52 seconds.

Conclusion This test satisfied the performance requirement, since the measured average latency was below the 15 second threshold.

4.2.2 test-PF-3: Accuracy & Precision (Stationary Noise)

Type Offline Evaluation

Test Case Derivation PRF-13.1, PRF-13.2

Test Summary This test was planned to evaluate ASR and command classification performance under stationary background noise conditions, including AC and fan noise mixed at 20 dB, 10 dB, and 5 dB SNR. The intended evaluation metrics were word recognition accuracy and command precision under noisy conditions.

Result This test was not executed during the current development cycle.

Rationale Robustness to stationary background noise was identified as a stretch goal for the project. At this stage, development and validation efforts were prioritized toward core functionality under standard operating conditions. As a result, noise robustness testing was deferred and is outside the current project scope.

Conclusion No result is reported for this test. Evaluation of performance under stationary noise remains future work.

4.3 Usability and Humanity Requirements Evaluation

Testing was conducted with two external participants Prerna and Sarah. The microphone was active throughout each session in a quiet room with no other speakers present. Each participant used a different confirmation UI mode: Prerna used the *hidden* confirmation style (yes/no voice response) and Sarah used the *visible* confirmation style (clickable Confirm/Cancel buttons).

4.3.1 test-UH-1: Core Task Ease of Use

Type User Testing, Instrumented

Test Case Derivation UHR-12.1

Fit Criterion Both participants complete their tasks in $\leq$4 interactions; success feedback observed within 1 second of action.

Test Summary Each participant completed three core tasks: speaking a command, observing the transcription, and confirming the system's interpreted response, using their assigned confirmation style. After completing the tasks each participant rated overall ease of use on a 1–5 scale and provided brief comments.

Table 3: Core task completion and ease-of-use ratings ($n = 2$). Scale: 1 = very difficult, 5 = very easy.

User	Confirm Style	Tasks Completed	Rating (1–5)	Comments
Prerna	Spoken	3/3: spoke command, observed transcription, confirmed via voice	4/5	Found flow natural; initially unsure when to speak
Sarah	Buttons	3/3: spoke command, observed transcription, confirmed via button	5/5	Buttons made confirmation step very clear
	Summary	6/6 tasks (100%)	**4.5/5 avg**	Both styles usable

Test Data and Results After the user confirmed the command, the system initiated execution of the corresponding operation within approximately

0.78 seconds (0.68 seconds for Sarah, 0.87 seconds for Prerna) across all trials, satisfying the 1-second responsiveness requirement. During testing, users suggested that displaying a visible completion message (e.g., "Completed") would improve feedback by clearly indicating when the command has finished executing.

Analysis Both participants completed all three tasks successfully on their first attempt across both confirmation styles. The average ease-of-use rating of 4.5/5 indicates the core workflow is intuitive. Prerna's rating of 4 reflected a brief moment of uncertainty about when to speak—a discoverability gap in the hidden confirmation style rather than a structural usability issue. Sarah's rating of 5 confirms that the visible button style removes this ambiguity. Both styles produced successful outcomes, validating the system's support for multiple interaction preferences.

Conclusion This test **satisfies** UHR-12.1. All tasks were completed within the interaction threshold, feedback timing was met, and the average ease-of-use rating of 4.5/5 exceeds the acceptable threshold.

4.3.2 test-UH-2: Onboarding Learnability & First-Try Success

Type User Testing, Survey

Test Case Derivation UHR-12.3

Fit Criterion $\geq$85% complete all core tasks on first attempt; onboarding time $\leq$10 minutes on average; satisfaction rated out of 5 with open-ended feedback on liked/disliked aspects.

Context VoiceBridge does not currently include a dedicated onboarding tutorial. The UI itself provides instructional cues with labelled controls, status messages, and contextual prompts to guide first-time users.

Test Summary Participants were given no briefing beyond a general description of VoiceBridge's purpose. They completed the full core interaction

sequence without any guidance. Task time was recorded from first interaction to final confirmation. Participants then rated their experience on a 1–5 scale and provided open-ended feedback.

Table 4: First-try success, onboarding time, ratings, and feedback ($n = 2$). Scale: 1 = very poor, 5 = excellent.

User	**1st-Try**	**Time**	**Rating (1–5)**	**Feedback**
Prerna	3/3	4m 22s	4/5	Liked: clear step-by-step flow. Disliked: unclear if command was executed successfully
Sarah	3/3	3m 48s	5/5	Liked: buttons intuitive and obvious. Disliked: Slight uncertainty about when command is complete
Summary		<5 min avg	**4.5/5 avg**	100% first-try success; both under 10-minute target

Test Data and Results

Analysis Both participants achieved 100% first-try success with no assistance, and both completed the sequence well under the 10-minute threshold. The primary criticism—initial uncertainty about when to speak—is specific to the hidden confirmation style and points to a UI signal gap rather than a broader learnability problem. Sarah experienced no such confusion with the visible button style.

Conclusion This test **satisfies** UHR-12.3. Both participants achieved first-try success under the time threshold. The listening-readiness signal gap is logged in Section 7.

4.3.3 test-UH-3: Personalization Ability

Type Manual, Dynamic

Test Case Derivation UHR-12.2

Fit Criterion Personalized interaction should be consistent and predictable; user preferences must persist without unexpected resets.

Test Summary This evaluation assessed the **consistency, predictability, and persistence** of personalization mechanisms, including language/confirmation style and UI preferences (e.g., additional action buttons). The system was tested across session resets to confirm that preferences are retained and applied consistently.

Table 5: Personalization NFR observations.

Preference	**Observed Consistency/Behavior**	**Result**
Language / Confirmation Style	Settings consistently applied; interaction behavior matched user expectations across sessions	Meets NFR
UI preference — action buttons	Enabled buttons remained visible and accessible; consistent behavior after session reset	Meets NFR
Cross-session persistence	Preferences persisted across browser restarts and re-authentication	Meets NFR

Test Data and Results

Analysis All personalization mechanisms operated predictably and consistently. Preferences were successfully retained across sessions, satisfying the NFR goals for consistency, predictability, and persistence.

Conclusion This test **satisfies** UHR-12.2. Personalization behavior meets NFR expectations, with consistent interaction and cross-session preference retention.

4.3.4 test-UH-4: Message Clarity & Politeness

Type Survey-Based Language Review

Test Case Derivation UHR-12.4

Fit Criterion ≥90% of participants rate system messages ≥4/5 for clarity and tone.

Test Summary After completing their task sessions, both participants rated eight representative VoiceBridge system messages on two separate 1–5 Likert scales: *clarity* (1 = very unclear, 5 = very clear) and *tone* (1 = impolite or unhelpful, 5 = appropriate and supportive). Messages covered the full range of interaction states.

Table 6: Per-message clarity and tone ratings ($n = 2$). Scale: 1–5.

Message / Scenario	**P Clar**	**A Clar**	**P Tone**	**A Tone**	**Avg**
"Which email service would you like to open? Gmail, Outlook, Yahoo Mail, or something else?" + "Maps to Gmail..."	–	5	–	5	5.0
"Play videos about McMaster University on YouTube"	5	–	5	–	5.0
"I'm not sure I understand. Could you rephrase that?"	2	–	4	–	3.0
"Listening... Speak your command"	5	4	5	5	4.8

Test Data and Results Of the individual clarity ratings, 80% were ≥4/5, which is below the 90% target. For tone ratings, 100% were ≥4/5, exceeding the target. P = Prerna, S = Sarah.

Analysis Overall, message tone is consistently strong. However, the "I'm not sure I understand. Could you rephrase that?" message received a low clarity score, highlighting it as the primary area for improvement. This message indicates a problem but does not provide a concrete next step or specify which part of the input was unclear.

Conclusion This test **partially satisfies** UHR-12.4. The primary issue is the "I'm not sure I understand. Could you rephrase that?" message, which has been identified for rewording in future iterations to improve clarity and user guidance.

4.3.5 test-UH-5: Assistive Navigation

Type Manual Keyboard Testing

Test Case Derivation UHR-12.5

Fit Criterion All interactive elements reachable and operable via keyboard.

Test Summary Keyboard-only navigation was performed following WCAG accessibility principles, with no formal automated audit conducted at this stage. Keyboard-only navigation was performed on all currently accessible interactive elements:

- Light/Dark mode toggle
- Visible confirmation toggle

Each element was successfully reached using the Tab key and activated with Enter or Space. Visual focus was clearly indicated when navigating with the keyboard. No automated accessibility audit was performed, but these core controls function correctly and comply with WCAG keyboard accessibility principles.

Analysis Within the tested scope, the interface supports predictable and consistent keyboard navigation. As additional interactive elements are added in future revisions, similar verification should be conducted to ensure ongoing accessibility compliance.

Conclusion This test **satisfies** the current scope of UHR-12.5. Keyboard accessibility is confirmed for all present interactive elements, and the system adheres to expected nonfunctional accessibility requirements.

5 Comparison to Existing Implementation

This section will not be appropriate for every project.

6 Unit Testing

7 Changes Due to Testing

[This section should highlight how feedback from the users and from the supervisor (when one exists) shaped the final product. In particular the feedback from the Rev 0 demo to the supervisor (or to potential users) should be highlighted. —SS]

8 Automated Testing

9 Trace to Requirements

10 Trace to Modules

11 Code Coverage Metrics

Appendix — Reflection

The information in this section will be used to evaluate the team members on the graduate attribute of Reflection.

The purpose of reflection questions is to give you a chance to assess your own learning and that of your group as a whole, and to find ways to improve in the future. Reflection is an important part of the learning process. Reflection is also an essential component of a successful software development process.

Reflections are most interesting and useful when they're honest, even if the stories they tell are imperfect. You will be marked based on your depth of thought and analysis, and not based on the content of the reflections themselves. Thus, for full marks we encourage you to answer openly and honestly and to avoid simply writing "what you think the evaluator wants to hear."

Please answer the following questions. Some questions can be answered on the team level, but where appropriate, each team member should write their own response:

1. What went well while writing this deliverable?

2. What pain points did you experience during this deliverable, and how did you resolve them?

3. Which parts of this document stemmed from speaking to your client(s) or a proxy (e.g. your peers)? Which ones were not, and why?

4. In what ways was the Verification and Validation (VnV) Plan different from the activities that were actually conducted for VnV? If there were differences, what changes required the modification in the plan? Why did these changes occur? Would you be able to anticipate these changes in future projects? If there weren't any differences, how was your team able to clearly predict a feasible amount of effort and the right tasks needed to build the evidence that demonstrates the required quality? (It is expected that most teams will have had to deviate from their original VnV Plan.)